

CHARLES DARWIN

On the Origin of Species

1859

COMMONPLACE

There is grandeur in this view of life, with its several powers, having been originally breathed into a few forms or into one; and that, whilst this planet has gone cycling on according to the fixed law of gravity, from so simple a beginning endless forms most beautiful and most wonderful have been, and are being, evolved.

— closing paragraph

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The one sentence in the book where he lets himself write like this. Worth noticing that “the fixed law of gravity” is the anchor he reaches for when he wants to sound certain — physics as the thing biology borrows authority from.
